

Advantages and Disadvantages

Team ID	SWUID2026136950
Project Name	Automated Network Request Management in ServiceNow

ADVANTAGES

1. End-to-End Automation

The entire lifecycle from submission to closure is automated using Flow Designer. No manual intervention is required at any stage - approval, task creation, fulfillment, and closure all happen automatically.

2. Standardized Process

Every network request follows the same standard format. This eliminates the inconsistency of emails and phone calls, ensuring complete and accurate data capture.

3. Full Audit Trail

Every action, approval, and state change is logged automatically. This makes compliance and audit preparation fast and reliable - critical for regulated industries.

4. Faster Fulfillment

Average request fulfillment time is reduced from 3-5 days to under 1 day. Approvals are routed automatically, and tasks are assigned immediately after approval.

5. SLA Tracking

A 4-hour SLA tracks approval time. Managers can see how long approvals take and identify bottlenecks. Breach notifications ensure timely escalation.

6. Real-Time Notifications

8 email notifications keep all stakeholders informed at every stage - submission, approval, escalation, completion, and feedback.

7. Role-Based Security

Three roles (requester, approver, engineer) and ACLs ensure that only authorized users can access or modify records. This prevents unauthorized changes.

8. Priority-Based Routing

Requests can be marked as Critical, High, Medium, or Low. High-priority requests get faster attention, improving operational efficiency.

9. Auto-Escalation

If approvals are pending beyond 2 hours, they are automatically escalated to management. This prevents requests from getting stuck.

10. Reporting and Visibility

3 reports and a management dashboard provide real-time visibility into request volume, task performance, and SLA compliance.

11. Feedback Collection

A post-completion survey collects requester feedback, enabling continuous improvement of the service.

12. Request Cancellation

Users can cancel their own requests before approval, giving them control and reducing unnecessary workload for IT.

DISADVANTAGES

1. Platform Dependency

The solution is built entirely on ServiceNow. Organizations that don't use ServiceNow would need to purchase a license, which can be expensive for small businesses.

2. Initial Setup Time

Configuring the flow, UI Policies, notifications, SLA, and reports requires significant initial setup time. It's not an out-of-the-box solution.

3. Learning Curve

Administrators and developers need to understand Flow Designer, Business Rules, ACLs, and UI Policies to maintain or extend the solution.

4. Limited to ServiceNow Features

The solution uses only ServiceNow's native capabilities. Complex integrations with external systems require additional development.

5. No Mobile Optimization

The Service Portal interface is functional but not optimized for mobile devices. Mobile users may have a suboptimal experience.

6. Manual Approval Decision

Although the approval workflow is automated, the approver must still manually review and decide. The system does not make automatic approval decisions.

7. No ML/AI Integration

The current solution does not use machine learning for intelligent routing or predictive analysis. This could be a future enhancement.

8. Limited Reporting

The reports are basic. Advanced analytics with trend analysis, forecasting, and root cause analysis would require Performance Analytics, which is a premium feature.

9. Single-Language Support

Notifications and UI text are in English only. Multi-language support would require additional configuration.

10. No Multi-Level Approval

The current flow supports single-level approval. High-risk requests might need multi-level approval, which is not currently implemented.